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Azure AI Architecture: What They Don't Teach in Tutorials (The Messy Reality of Production AI)



Sridhar

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11 min read · Jun 19, 2025

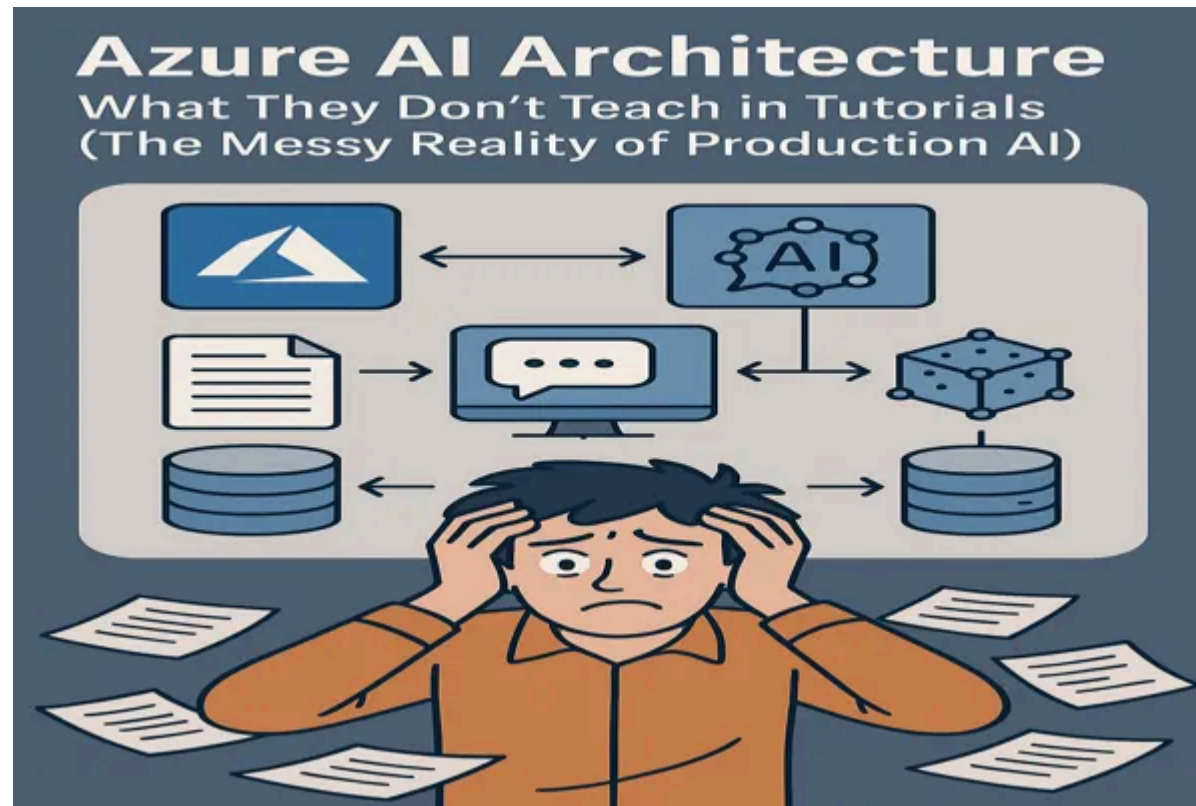


282



19





A freelance architect's brutally honest take on building AI systems that actually work in the real world

The tutorial said it would take 30 minutes.

Six weeks later, I was still debugging why our “simple” AI-powered document analysis system kept choking on PDFs that weren't perfectly formatted. The client was breathing down my neck, the Azure bill had ballooned to \$3,130

for the month and I was questioning every life choice that led me to say “sure, AI integration sounds straightforward.”

Here's what every Azure AI tutorial conveniently leaves out: **the real work starts after the demo works.**

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Sridhar put this story behind our paywall, so it's only available to read with a paid Medium membership, which comes with a host of benefits:

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Upgrade



Written by Sridhar

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I write to connect—through tech, truth & tough times 🍷 | Mentor | Business Strategist | Here to inspire & be inspired

Responses (19)



Marc Vangoolen

What are your thoughts?



Toeser

Jul 13



This is by far the best article i read in the last 3 months here on Medium and i read a lot. Can you share articles that inspired you for setting up the foundation part (Infrastructure, Monitoring and stuff like that)? We build a lot of Azure... [more](#)



17



2 replies

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Sanky-2

Jul 22



Absolutely Agreed with Toeser by far one of the best articles which hits all the pain points we encounter while implementing AI solutions



7

[Reply](#)



Aswin Win

Aug 5



Very well written

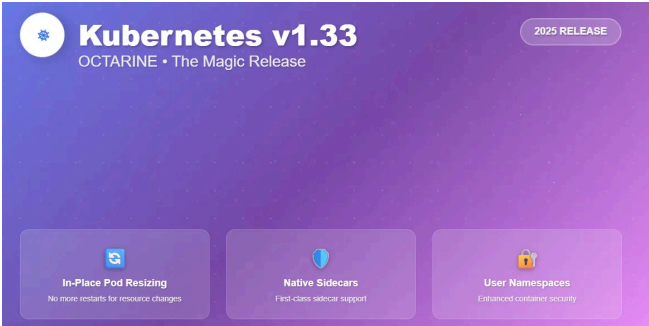


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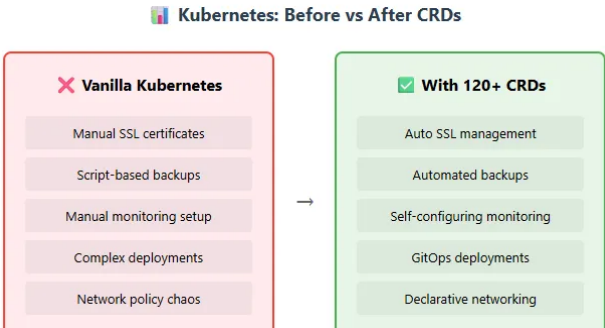


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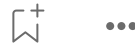


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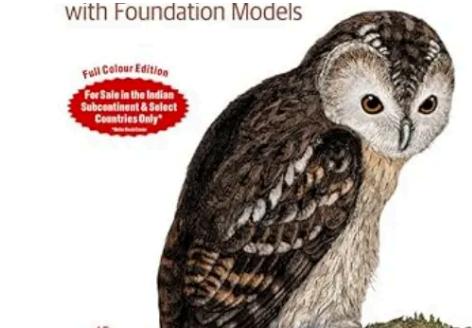
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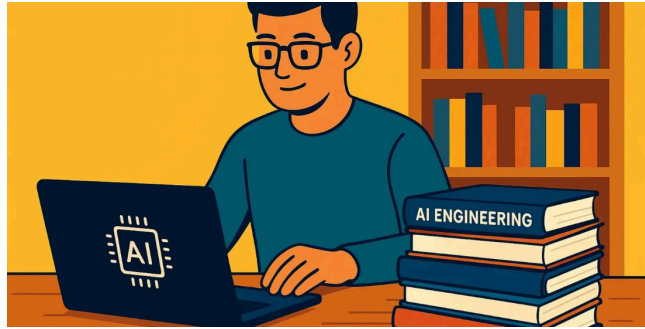


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